

Lincoln's murder was unprecedented at the time—no previous president had ever been assassinated. His death deprived the nation of sound leadership, while his successor, Andrew Johnson, was generally considered lacking in wise counsel. Some Unreconciled Confederates applauded Booth's deed; however, the bulk of the nation was united in grief. Although federal authorities were at first suspicious of a Confederate conspiracy, Lincoln's death helped bind the nation in common sympathy.



Lincoln's hat

Despite his impressive height of 6ft 4in (1.9m), Lincoln was renowned for wearing tall or high hats. On the night of his assassination, he wore this one, now in the Museum of American History, Smithsonian Institution.